

JAMES COLLINGTON

Oxford, United Kingdom

Email: james.collington@gmail.com

Phone: +44 7891 234567

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jamescollington

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Engineer with 12 years building and scaling backend systems for high-traffic applications. I've spent the last six years moving between infrastructure and platform teams, and I've developed a particular interest in reliability engineering and distributed systems. I work well across teams, enjoy mentoring junior engineers, and I'm happiest when solving problems that involve both technical depth and cross-functional collaboration.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Meridian Systems

meridian-systems.io

Oxford, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Designed and implemented a new service mesh architecture that reduced inter-service latency by 40 percent and improved observability across our 15-microservice platform. Led the migration of our monolithic authentication system into a distributed service, handling 2 million daily requests with 99.99 percent uptime. Established standards for infrastructure-as-code practices across engineering teams and reduced infrastructure provisioning time from 2 weeks to 4 hours. Mentored four junior engineers through promotion cycles and created a structured technical career progression framework for individual contributors.

Senior Backend Engineer

CloudVault Ltd

cloudvault.co.uk

London, United Kingdom

July 2017 - February 2021

Architected and launched a distributed data replication system that allowed customers to synchronize data across multiple regions with sub-second latency. Reduced database query response times by 60 percent through careful optimization and the introduction of intelligent caching strategies. Built and maintained a team of five engineers, conducting technical interviews and defining code review practices that became the standard across the backend organization. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting that reduced mean time to recovery for incidents from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Senior Software Engineer

Nexus Technologies

nexus-tech.net

Cambridge, United Kingdom

January 2012 - June 2017

Developed and maintained core payment processing services handling GBP 50 million in annual transactions, ensuring PCI DSS compliance and zero security incidents. Migrated legacy systems from a single database to PostgreSQL with read replicas, improving query performance by 70 percent and enabling horizontal scaling. Created API documentation standards and led workshops that improved time-to-productivity for new team

members from six weeks to two weeks. Debugged and resolved critical production issues involving complex database locking scenarios and race conditions in concurrent systems.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Oxford

Oxford, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2011

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Runtimes: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Bash

Databases and Storage: PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, DynamoDB, S3

Infrastructure and DevOps: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP, Jenkins, Prometheus

Distributed Systems: Microservices architecture, service mesh, message queues, distributed tracing

Tools and Practices: Git, code review, API design, incident response, capacity planning